



THE CAKE COOKBOOK

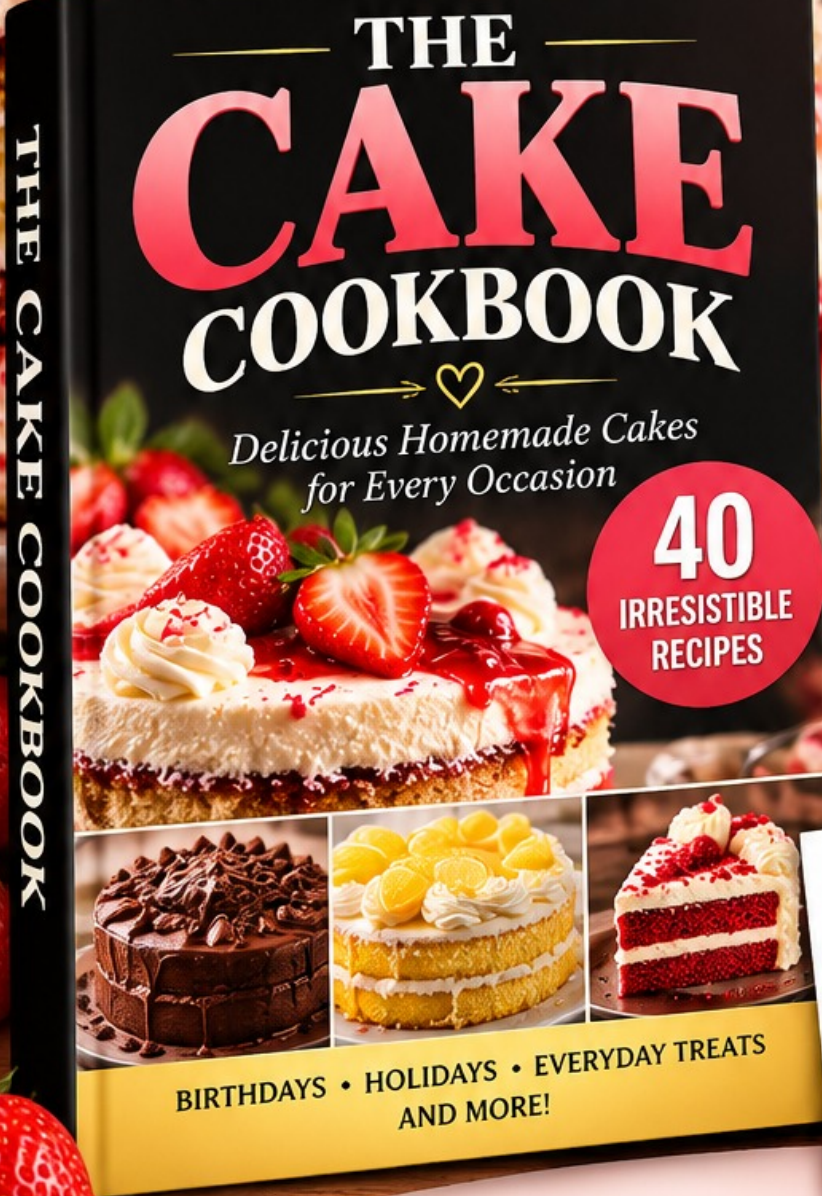
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for Every Occasion*

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THE CAKE COOKBOOK

40 Delicious Homemade Cakes for Every Occasion



40 RECIPES

Classic favorites • Easy homemade cakes • Frostings & finishing ideas

PLUS 5 BONUS FROSTINGS & GLAZES

A practical digital cookbook created for home bakers.

Welcome to The Cake Cookbook

This collection is designed for home bakers who want approachable cakes without complicated techniques. Each recipe includes a straightforward ingredient list and simple method. For best results, measure ingredients carefully, use room-temperature dairy and eggs when practical, and allow cakes to cool completely before frosting.

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01. Classic Vanilla Celebration Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup unsalted butter, softened
- 1 cup granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 3/4 cup milk

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Grease and line two 8-inch round pans.
2. Whisk flour, baking powder, and salt. In another bowl, beat butter and sugar until light.
3. Beat in eggs one at a time, then vanilla. Add dry ingredients alternately with milk.
4. Divide between pans and bake 24–28 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean.
5. Cool 10 minutes in pans, then transfer to a rack. Fill and frost as desired.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

02. Rich Chocolate Fudge Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 3/4 cup unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup neutral oil
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch round pans.
2. Whisk flour, cocoa, sugar, baking soda, baking powder, and salt.
3. Add eggs, buttermilk, oil, and vanilla. Mix until combined.
4. Slowly stir in hot coffee; batter will be thin.
5. Bake 28–32 minutes. Cool completely before frosting.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

03. Strawberry Cream Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter, softened
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1 1/2 cups sliced strawberries
- 1 cup heavy cream
- 2 tbsp powdered sugar

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Mix flour, baking powder, and salt. Cream butter and sugar; beat in eggs and vanilla.
3. Add dry ingredients alternately with milk. Bake 24–28 minutes and cool.
4. Whip cream with powdered sugar until soft peaks form.
5. Layer cake with whipped cream and strawberries. Chill before slicing.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

04. Lemon Drizzle Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tbsp lemon zest
- 1/2 cup milk
- 1/3 cup lemon juice
- 1 cup powdered sugar

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Grease a 9-inch loaf pan.
2. Whisk flour, baking powder, and salt. Cream butter and sugar, then add eggs and zest.
3. Mix in dry ingredients and milk. Bake 45–50 minutes.
4. Combine lemon juice with powdered sugar.
5. While warm, poke the cake and spoon over the drizzle. Cool before serving.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

05. Red Velvet Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/2 cups flour
- 1 tbsp cocoa powder
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 3/4 cup neutral oil
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 tbsp red food coloring
- 1 tsp vinegar

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 9-inch pans.
2. Whisk flour, cocoa, baking soda, and salt. Mix sugar, buttermilk, oil, eggs, vanilla, coloring, and vinegar.
3. Fold wet into dry just until combined.
4. Bake 25–30 minutes. Cool completely.
5. Pair with cream cheese frosting and chill before serving.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

06. Carrot Cake with Cream Cheese Frosting

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 1/2 cup granulated sugar
- 3 eggs
- 3/4 cup oil
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 2 cups finely grated carrots
- 1/2 cup chopped walnuts

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Whisk flour, cinnamon, baking soda, and salt. In another bowl whisk sugars, eggs, oil, and vanilla.
3. Stir wet into dry. Fold in carrots and walnuts.
4. Bake 28–32 minutes and cool completely.
5. Frost with cream cheese frosting and refrigerate until firm.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

07. Coconut Cream Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup coconut milk
- 1 cup sweetened shredded coconut
- 1 cup heavy cream
- 2 tbsp powdered sugar

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Combine flour, baking powder, and salt. Cream butter and sugar; add eggs and vanilla.
3. Mix in dry ingredients and coconut milk. Fold in coconut.
4. Bake 24–28 minutes. Cool completely.
5. Whip cream with powdered sugar and use as filling and topping.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

08. Banana Walnut Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup butter
- 3/4 cup brown sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3 ripe bananas, mashed
- 1/2 cup chopped walnuts
- 1/4 cup milk

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare a 9-inch round pan.
2. Whisk flour, baking soda, and salt. Cream butter and sugar; add eggs and vanilla.
3. Mix in bananas and milk, then fold in dry ingredients and walnuts.
4. Bake 35–40 minutes.
5. Cool completely and serve plain or with vanilla frosting.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

09. Blueberry Lemon Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 2 tbsp lemon zest
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1 1/2 cups blueberries

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Mix flour, baking powder, and salt. Cream butter and sugar; beat in eggs, vanilla, and zest.
3. Add dry ingredients alternately with milk. Fold in blueberries.
4. Bake 25–30 minutes. Cool before frosting.
5. Finish with lemon glaze or vanilla buttercream.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

10. Funfetti Birthday Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1/2 cup rainbow sprinkles

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Whisk dry ingredients. Cream butter and sugar; beat in eggs and vanilla.
3. Mix in dry ingredients and milk. Fold in sprinkles last.
4. Bake 24–28 minutes.
5. Cool and decorate with vanilla frosting and extra sprinkles.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

11. Cookies and Cream Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 12 chocolate sandwich cookies, crushed

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Mix flour, baking powder, and salt. Cream butter and sugar; add eggs and vanilla.
3. Add milk and dry ingredients. Fold in crushed cookies.
4. Bake 24–28 minutes and cool.
5. Fold extra cookie crumbs into vanilla frosting and layer the cake.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

12. Chocolate Peanut Butter Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa powder
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee
- 1 cup creamy peanut butter

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Whisk flour, cocoa, sugar, and baking soda. Add eggs, buttermilk, oil, and vanilla.
3. Stir in coffee. Bake 28–32 minutes and cool.
4. Warm peanut butter slightly so it spreads easily.
5. Layer cake with peanut butter frosting and chocolate frosting.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

13. Apple Cinnamon Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 2 apples, peeled and diced

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Grease a 9-inch round pan.
2. Whisk dry ingredients. Cream butter and sugar; add eggs and vanilla.
3. Mix in dry ingredients and milk. Fold in apples.
4. Bake 38–45 minutes.
5. Dust with powdered sugar or drizzle with simple vanilla glaze.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

14. Pumpkin Spice Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp ginger
- 1/4 tsp nutmeg
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup pumpkin puree
- 3/4 cup oil
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 3 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Whisk flour, leaveners, spices, and salt.
3. Whisk pumpkin, oil, sugar, eggs, and vanilla.
4. Combine wet and dry just until smooth. Bake 28–32 minutes.
5. Cool and top with cream cheese frosting.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

15. Marble Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1/3 cup cocoa powder
- 2 tbsp extra milk

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare a 9-inch round pan.
2. Mix a vanilla batter from flour, baking powder, salt, butter, sugar, eggs, vanilla, and milk.
3. Remove one-third of batter and stir in cocoa and extra milk.
4. Alternate spoonfuls of vanilla and chocolate batter; swirl gently.
5. Bake 35–40 minutes and cool.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

16. Orange Cream Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tbsp orange zest
- 1/2 cup orange juice
- 1/4 cup milk
- 1 tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Whisk dry ingredients. Cream butter and sugar; beat in eggs, zest, vanilla, and juice.
3. Add dry ingredients alternately with milk.
4. Bake 24–28 minutes and cool.
5. Fill with whipped cream and finish with orange zest.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

17. Coffee Cake with Cinnamon Streusel

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 3/4 cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1/2 cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1/3 cup flour
- 3 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare a 9-inch square pan.
2. Make batter with flour, baking powder, salt, butter, sugar, eggs, vanilla, and milk.
3. For streusel, rub brown sugar, cinnamon, flour, and butter together.
4. Spread batter in pan and sprinkle streusel over top.
5. Bake 35–40 minutes. Cool slightly before slicing.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

18. Chocolate Chip Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1 cup mini chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Whisk dry ingredients. Cream butter and sugar; beat in eggs and vanilla.
3. Mix in milk and dry ingredients. Fold in chocolate chips.
4. Bake 24–28 minutes.
5. Cool and finish with chocolate or vanilla buttercream.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

19. Raspberry Vanilla Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1 cup raspberries

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Combine dry ingredients. Cream butter and sugar; beat in eggs and vanilla.
3. Add milk and dry ingredients. Gently fold in raspberries.
4. Bake 24–28 minutes and cool.
5. Layer with vanilla buttercream and raspberry jam.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

20. S'mores Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee
- 1 cup graham cracker crumbs
- 1 cup mini marshmallows

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make chocolate cake batter and bake 28–32 minutes.
3. Cool completely. Spread chocolate frosting between layers.
4. Add graham crumbs and mini marshmallows between layers.
5. Top with frosting, graham crumbs, and toasted marshmallows.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

21. Vanilla Berry Sheet Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 2 cups mixed berries

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Line a 9x13-inch pan.
2. Make vanilla batter with flour, baking powder, salt, butter, sugar, eggs, vanilla, and milk.
3. Spread into pan and scatter berries over the top.
4. Bake 30–35 minutes.
5. Cool, dust with powdered sugar, and cut into squares.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

22. Chocolate Orange Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee
- 2 tbsp orange zest

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Whisk dry ingredients. Mix wet ingredients with orange zest.
3. Combine and slowly stir in hot coffee.
4. Bake 28–32 minutes and cool.
5. Frost with chocolate buttercream and add orange zest.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

23. Peach Upside-Down Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 3 peaches, thinly sliced
- 1/4 cup brown sugar
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 1/2 cups flour
- 1 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup butter
- 3/4 cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1/2 cup milk

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Melt butter in a 9-inch round pan and sprinkle brown sugar over it.
2. Arrange peach slices over the sugar.
3. Make batter with flour, baking powder, salt, butter, sugar, eggs, vanilla, and milk.
4. Spread over peaches and bake 40–45 minutes.
5. Rest 10 minutes, then carefully invert onto a plate.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

24. Strawberry Shortcake Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup butter
- 3/4 cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 2 cups sliced strawberries
- 1 cup heavy cream
- 2 tbsp powdered sugar

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make a simple vanilla cake batter and bake 24–28 minutes.
3. Cool completely. Whip cream with powdered sugar.
4. Layer cake, whipped cream, and strawberries.
5. Finish with berries on top and chill 30 minutes before serving.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

25. Salted Caramel Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 3 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1/2 cup caramel sauce
- 1/2 tsp flaky sea salt

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make brown-sugar vanilla cake batter and bake 24–28 minutes.
3. Cool completely and frost with vanilla buttercream.
4. Drizzle caramel between layers and over the top.
5. Finish with a small pinch of flaky sea salt.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

26. Cinnamon Roll Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1/2 cup brown sugar
- 2 tsp cinnamon

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare a 9-inch square pan.
2. Make vanilla cake batter and spread half in the pan.
3. Mix brown sugar, cinnamon, and 2 tbsp softened butter; dollop over batter.
4. Top with remaining batter and swirl with a knife.
5. Bake 35–40 minutes. Drizzle with vanilla glaze while warm.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

27. Chocolate Raspberry Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee
- 1 cup raspberry jam

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make chocolate cake batter and bake 28–32 minutes.
3. Cool completely and slice each layer if desired.
4. Spread raspberry jam between layers with chocolate frosting.
5. Finish with raspberries and chocolate curls.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

28. Lemon Blueberry Loaf Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tbsp lemon zest
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1 1/4 cups blueberries

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Grease a 9x5-inch loaf pan.
2. Mix dry ingredients. Cream butter and sugar; add eggs, zest, and vanilla.
3. Mix in milk and dry ingredients, then fold in blueberries.
4. Bake 50–60 minutes.
5. Cool and drizzle with lemon glaze.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

29. Chocolate Coconut Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee
- 1 cup shredded coconut

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make chocolate batter and fold in half the coconut.
3. Bake 28–32 minutes and cool.
4. Frost with chocolate buttercream.
5. Press remaining coconut over the frosting.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

30. Mocha Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make chocolate batter, using the hot coffee to deepen the flavor.
3. Bake 28–32 minutes and cool.
4. Make coffee buttercream by adding 1–2 tsp instant espresso powder to vanilla frosting.
5. Fill and frost the cake; dust lightly with cocoa.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

31. Black Forest Inspired Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee
- 1 cup cherry pie filling
- 1 cup whipped cream

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Bake the chocolate cake for 28–32 minutes and cool completely.
3. Spread cherry filling and whipped cream between layers.
4. Cover lightly with chocolate frosting or whipped cream.
5. Top with cherries and chocolate shavings.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

32. Honey Vanilla Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1/2 cup honey
- 1/2 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Whisk dry ingredients. Cream butter, honey, and sugar.
3. Beat in eggs and vanilla. Add dry ingredients alternately with milk.
4. Bake 24–28 minutes.
5. Cool and finish with vanilla frosting and a light honey drizzle.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

33. Maple Pecan Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 3/4 cup brown sugar
- 1/4 cup maple syrup
- 3 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 3/4 cup chopped pecans

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Mix dry ingredients. Cream butter and sugar; add maple syrup, eggs, and vanilla.
3. Add milk and dry ingredients. Fold in pecans.
4. Bake 25–30 minutes.
5. Frost with vanilla buttercream and drizzle with maple syrup.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

34. Chocolate Mint Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee
- 1/4 tsp peppermint extract

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make chocolate batter and add peppermint extract.
3. Bake 28–32 minutes and cool.
4. Frost with chocolate buttercream lightly flavored with peppermint.
5. Decorate with chocolate shavings or mint candies.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

35. Raspberry Almond Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 1 tsp almond extract
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1 cup raspberries
- 1/3 cup sliced almonds

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make vanilla-almond batter and fold in raspberries.
3. Divide into pans and scatter almonds on top.
4. Bake 24–28 minutes.
5. Cool and finish with a thin almond glaze.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

36. Gingerbread Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp ginger
- 1/4 tsp cloves
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup butter
- 3/4 cup brown sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1/2 cup molasses
- 3/4 cup milk

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare a 9-inch square pan.
2. Whisk flour, baking soda, spices, and salt.
3. Cream butter and sugar; beat in eggs and molasses.
4. Mix in dry ingredients and milk. Bake 35–40 minutes.
5. Serve with whipped cream or cream cheese frosting.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

37. Classic Marble Bundt Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 1/2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 cup butter
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 4 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup milk
- 1/3 cup cocoa powder

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Grease and flour a 10-inch Bundt pan.
2. Make vanilla batter. Transfer one-third to another bowl and mix in cocoa.
3. Alternate batters in the Bundt pan and swirl gently.
4. Bake 50–60 minutes, until a skewer comes out clean.
5. Cool 15 minutes before turning out. Glaze if desired.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

38. Chocolate Sheet Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 cups sugar
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Line a 9x13-inch pan.
2. Whisk dry ingredients. Add eggs, buttermilk, oil, and vanilla.
3. Stir in hot coffee and pour into the pan.
4. Bake 25–30 minutes.
5. Cool and spread with chocolate frosting before slicing.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

39. Vanilla Berry Birthday Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 3/4 cup milk
- 1 cup berry jam

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make vanilla cake batter and bake 24–28 minutes.
3. Cool completely and spread berry jam over one layer.
4. Add vanilla buttercream and top with second layer.
5. Decorate with fresh berries and sprinkles.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

40. Chocolate Hazelnut Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 3/4 cups flour
- 3/4 cup cocoa
- 1 3/4 cups sugar
- 1 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup buttermilk
- 1/2 cup oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup hot coffee
- 3/4 cup chocolate-hazelnut spread
- 1/2 cup chopped hazelnuts

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 350°F. Prepare two 8-inch pans.
2. Make chocolate batter and bake 28–32 minutes.
3. Cool and spread chocolate-hazelnut spread between layers.
4. Frost the outside with chocolate buttercream.
5. Finish with chopped hazelnuts.

Serving idea: Let the cake cool completely before decorating. For cleaner slices, chill frosted cakes for 20–30 minutes before serving.

BONUS: 5 Easy Frostings & Glazes

Use these simple finishes to customize the cakes in this cookbook. Frostings are best used once cakes are completely cool.

Easy Vanilla Buttercream

Ingredients: 1 cup butter, softened • 3 cups powdered sugar • 2 tsp vanilla • 2–4 tbsp milk

Method: Beat butter until fluffy. Add powdered sugar gradually, then vanilla. Add milk a little at a time until spreadable.

Chocolate Buttercream

Ingredients: 1 cup butter, softened • 3 cups powdered sugar • 1/2 cup cocoa powder • 2 tsp vanilla • 3–4 tbsp milk

Method: Beat butter. Add powdered sugar and cocoa gradually. Beat in vanilla and milk until smooth.

Cream Cheese Frosting

Ingredients: 8 oz cream cheese, softened • 1/2 cup butter, softened • 3 cups powdered sugar • 1 tsp vanilla

Method: Beat cream cheese and butter until smooth. Add powdered sugar gradually and finish with vanilla. Chill if too soft.

Lemon Glaze

Ingredients: 1 cup powdered sugar • 2–3 tbsp lemon juice • 1 tsp lemon zest

Method: Whisk together until smooth and drizzle over a cooled cake.

Quick Caramel Sauce

Ingredients: 1 cup brown sugar • 1/2 cup butter • 1/2 cup heavy cream • 1 tsp vanilla • Pinch of salt

Method: Melt brown sugar and butter together. Stir in cream and simmer gently 2–3 minutes. Remove from heat and add vanilla and salt.

Simple Cake Decorating Cheat Sheet

Finish	Easy way to use it
Smooth buttercream	Spread a thin crumb coat, chill, then add the final layer.
Berry finish	Pile fresh berries in the center and dust lightly with powdered sugar.
Chocolate finish	Add chocolate curls, mini chips, or a light cocoa dusting.
Drizzle	Spoon glaze from the center outward and let it naturally run down the sides.
Birthday look	Add sprinkles around the top edge and a few candles at serving time.

Baking Notes

Oven temperatures can vary. Use visual cues and a toothpick/skewer to check doneness. Cakes should be cooled fully before frosting. Store cakes according to their frosting and fillings; cakes containing cream cheese, whipped cream, or fresh fruit should be refrigerated.